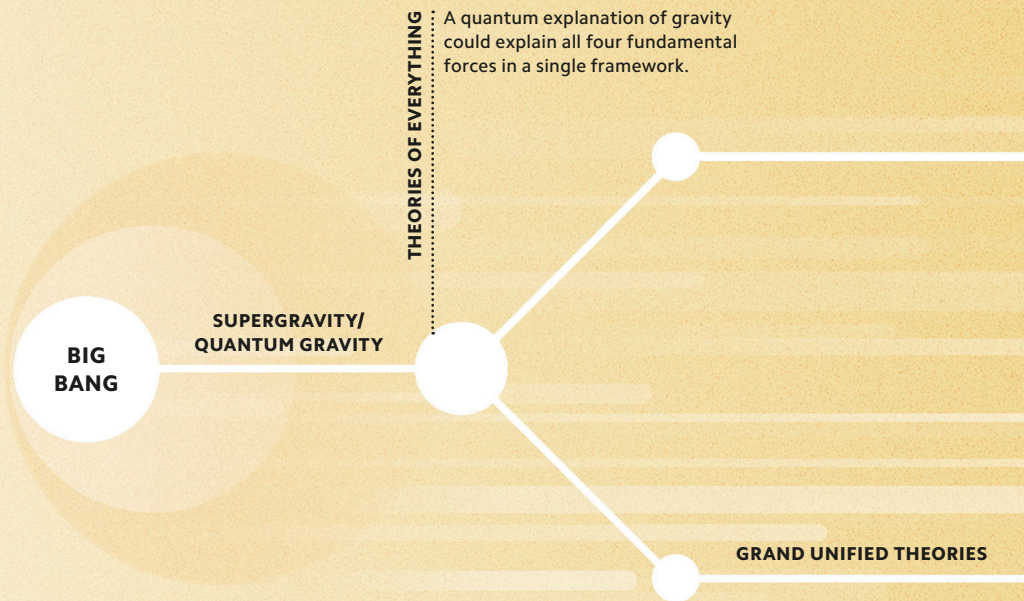




All in one

A theory of everything predicts that, at exceedingly high energies—such as just after the Big Bang—the four fundamental forces are united into one “superforce.”

COMBINED FORCES

In the 20th century, physics coalesced into two frameworks: quantum mechanics and General Relativity. If these could be unified in a single theory, it would describe all phenomena in the universe: a “theory of everything.” This is a Herculean task because according to General Relativity, gravity is not a force, but a property of space-time (see p.23). All efforts to model gravity as a quantum force (like other fundamental forces) have fallen short.